

CTF Write-up: Travellers – A Little Too Urban

Category: OSINT • Points: 496

Challenge Overview

This challenge focused on geolocating a suspect based on an urban photograph shared online by another member of the “Travellers” group.

Objective: Identify where the image was taken and determine the nearest club to that location.

- **Target:** Fourth member of the Travellers group
- **Goal:** Find the nearest club
- **Flag Format:** SK-CERT{Club_name}

Phase 1: Target Identification

The provided image, `travellers_part4.jpg`, showed a dense urban environment covered in heavy fog.

Key Visual Clues

- Modern glass-fronted office buildings
- Clearly visible building number: `67a`
- Blue-glass skyscraper under construction in the background
- Contemporary Central European city architecture

The skyscraper in the background was particularly distinctive.

Through architectural comparison and urban landmark searches, the tower was identified as:

`Šumavská Tower`

This landmark is located in:

Brno, Czech Republic

Phase 2: Exact Geolocation

After identifying the city, the next task was pinpointing the exact photographer position.

Step 1 — Analyze Building Address

The visible address 67a matched the Šumavská 67a business center.

Step 2 — Compare Urban Layout

The arrangement of roads, surrounding buildings, and the tower construction site aligned perfectly with the plaza outside Šumavská 67a.

Step 3 — Confirm Coordinates

The photographer’s position was determined to be approximately:

49.2104, 16.5966

Phase 3: Finding the Nearest Club

The challenge hinted that the suspect enjoyed clubbing, meaning the next objective was identifying the closest music club near the geolocated position.

Using the provided satellite image:

alterna club.jpg

a direct proximity analysis was performed.

Step 1 — Measure Nearby Distances

A measurement line of approximately 180.80 meters extended from the Šumavská 67a entrance.

Step 2 — Trace the Route

The line crossed Kounicova Street toward a university residential complex.

Step 3 — Identify Venue

The destination building contained:

Music Club Alterna

The proximity measurement strongly indicated that this was the intended club referenced by the challenge.

Phase 4: Verification

- **Distance:** Alterna Club was the closest nightlife venue within immediate walking distance.
- **Challenge Context:** The challenge title and description directly hinted at nightlife culture.
- **Urban Consistency:** The area surrounding Šumavská Tower contains student housing, making nearby clubs highly plausible meeting points.
- **Satellite Confirmation:** The provided measurement image aligned exactly with the club location.

Final Solution

The nearest club to the photographer’s location was identified as:

SK-CERT{Alterna_club}

Conclusion

This challenge demonstrated several important OSINT techniques:

- Urban geolocation analysis
- Architectural landmark recognition
- Address-based identification
- Satellite imagery proximity analysis
- Cross-referencing nightlife venues with map data

By combining environmental clues, city landmarks, and satellite measurements, the exact club nearest to the suspect’s position was successfully identified.